Coinbase Institutional

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RESEARCH & INSIGHTS HUB

Analyzing Solana Activity

An analysis of Solana's unique activity timing, its concentration of super users, and the importance of trading as a fee driver.

View report

Solana's unique transaction format and large blockchain history can pose challenges for analysis, which prevents the direct application of adoption metrics we've previously utilized for chains compatible with the Ethereum virtual machine (EVM). That said, we find that Solana's network metrics are broadly similar to other low fee chains according to an alternative set of activity distribution analytics.

Solana fee spending surges during US hours, mostly in line with activity patterns we've previously observed in both centralized and decentralized exchanges. However, Solana's peak activity timing is skewed later in the day towards Pacific Time Zone hours, suggesting it may have a distinct cohort of active users compared to other networks. Its high concentration of super users also appears in line with other low cost chains – 0.13% of accounts on Solana are responsible for 90% of total non-vote fee spend. Its overall fee spending is more reliant on DEX trading compared to its peers though, with 75-90% of its transaction fees linked to DEX trades.

Separately, 26% percent of Solana transaction fees in 3Q24 were spent on failed transactions, down significantly from a peak of 55% in March. While still higher than other low cost chains like Base (which averaged 14% over 3Q24), Solana's fees spent on failed transactions is moving closer towards its peers' ranges. Although failed transactions don't have a direct impact on most consumer experiences, this relatively large component of fee spending on failed transactions is unique to Solana's non-deterministic transaction ordering mechanism.

For more details, see our full report.

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